

IS THIS SAFE?

Sarah stores freshly cooked potato salad in the refrigerator within one hour of cooking and consumes it within 3 days.

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

IS THIS SAFE?

James decides to wash fresh apples under running water before eating them without peeling.

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

IS THIS SAFE?

Lisa stores homemade garlic in oil at room temperature in a jar on her kitchen counter to use over the coming month.

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

IS THIS SAFE?

Tom leaves a cooked stew on the counter for 5 hours before refrigerating it.

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

IS THIS SAFE?

Alex prepares fermented cucumber pickles but skips sanitizing the jar and uses cucumbers with soft spots.

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

IS THIS SAFE?

Maria left a vacuum-sealed homemade dried jerky package unrefrigerated during a 3-day camping trip in warm weather.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

IS THIS SAFE?

John plans to can tomatoes at 5,000 feet elevation using a boiling water bath canner without adjusting processing time.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

IS THIS SAFE?

Emily prepares homemade salad dressing with fresh lemon juice and stores it in the refrigerator. She wonders if it is safe to keep it for 5 days before consuming it.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

IS THIS SAFE?

Julie selects fresh, firm peaches and washes them thoroughly. She peels, slices, and packs the peaches into hot sterilized jars, then covers them with a hot light syrup. She processes the jars in a boiling water canner for the recommended time at her altitude.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Mark prepares cherries by washing and pitting them. He packs them raw into clean, sterilized jars, fills with boiling water, leaving half-inch headspace, and processes them in a boiling water canner following tested recommendations.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Dana picks wild plums and decides to can them using a pressure canner because the plums are not very acidic. She uses a test from an unverified internet recipe without adding acid.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Tom jars fresh strawberries using a 'raw pack' method but does not heat the jars before filling. He leaves them at room temperature before processing 6 hours later in a boiling water canner.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

IS THIS SAFE?

Eric relies on the jar lids to seal fruit jam without adjusting processing time for his high-altitude location, which is 4,500 feet above sea level. He processes jars at sea-level time.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

IS THIS SAFE?

Laura decides to can peaches using a homemade syrup recipe with no added sugar because she wants a low-sugar option. She processes the jars in a boiling water bath using standard processing times.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Jessica picks Asian pears to can and decides to omit adding lemon juice, believing pears are acidic enough. She uses recipes for boiling water canning without modification.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Megan plans to can her home-harvested Asian pears using a boiling water canner. She washes, peels, and halves the pears but forgets to add lemon juice to the jars before processing. She uses the raw pack method with syrup and processes the jars for the recommended time at her altitude.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Maria canned a batch of salsa using a tested recipe that includes 5% vinegar, and she processed the jars in a boiling water canner for 20 minutes at her altitude of 2,000 feet.

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IS THIS SAFE?

John uses Roma tomatoes, peels and cores them, heats salsa ingredients to a boil, and fills hot jars, leaving 1/2 inch headspace before processing in a boiling water canner for 15 minutes at sea level.

IS THIS SAFE?

Sarah canned fresh tomatoes without adding any lemon juice or citric acid, assuming tomatoes are naturally acidic enough.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Mike canned a homemade salsa recipe but decided to double the fresh garlic and add fresh herbs before processing.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Lucy packed sliced fresh tomatoes raw into jars and processed them in a boiling water canner without adding any acid or pre-cooking the tomatoes.

IS THIS SAFE?

David canned a salsa recipe that called for vinegar, but he substituted lime juice instead, using the same amount.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Anna canned tomatoes with lemon juice added and processed the jars in boiling water canner at sea level, but she forgot to adjust the processing time for her altitude of 5,500 feet.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Tom packed a mixed vegetable salsa that included carrots, corn, and tomatoes and used a boiling water canner method following his tomato salsa recipe.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Jane pressure cans a batch of green beans following an OSU-tested recipe exactly, using a weighted pressure canner at 10 pounds pressure for 25 minutes at 1,000 feet elevation.

IS THIS SAFE?

Mark freezes fresh corn on the cob for long-term storage by blanching it in boiling water for 4 minutes, cooling it immediately in ice water, then packing it in freezer bags.

IS THIS SAFE?

Lara attempts to water bath can fresh green beans in quart jars using boiling water processing for 20 minutes at sea level.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Tom cans homemade salsa combining tomatoes, onions, and peppers following a family recipe without measuring vinegar or processing time.

IS THIS SAFE?

Steve stores freshly minced garlic in olive oil at room temperature for several days before refrigeration.

IS THIS SAFE?

Anna pressure cans cooked beef stew in pint jars using a dial-gauge pressure canner set at 10 pounds pressure, but she is unsure if her altitude adjustment is correct.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Ella ferments green beans in brine following a tested recipe but decides to store them in an airtight container indoors without monitoring temperature.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Susan followed a tested quick-pickle recipe exactly, using white distilled vinegar with 5% acidity, fresh dill, and soaked cucumbers in ice water before packing. She processed the jars immediately and stored them in a cool place.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Carlos made pickled eggs by submerging hard-cooked eggs in vinegar and spices, then storing the jars in the refrigerator immediately, planning to consume them within 3 weeks.

IS THIS SAFE?

Jenna reduced the vinegar in her pickle recipe to make the brine less sour but did not adjust any other ingredients or processing times.

IS THIS SAFE?

Mark soaked his cucumbers in pickling lime purchased from a garden center and did not rinse them thoroughly before pickling.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Lily packed raw vegetables into jars with vinegar and water but did not heat-process the jars before storage at room temperature.

IS THIS SAFE?

Anna wants to pickle her fresh cucumbers using a family recipe but is unsure whether it is tested or if the vinegar acidity is adequate.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Tom refrigerated his pickles immediately after packing using a quick-pickle method but noticed cloudiness in the brine after a few days.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Maria follows a recipe using traditional fruit, sugar, and pectin proportions for strawberry jam, boiling the mixture for the recommended time before sealing in sterilized jars and processing them in a boiling water bath for 10 minutes.

IS THIS SAFE?

John prepares freezer jam using fresh berries, adding the specified amount of commercial pectin and sugar, mixing thoroughly, and promptly filling sterilized containers to store in the freezer.

IS THIS SAFE?

Susan made pepper jelly using a family recipe but did not add any extra acid like lemon juice or vinegar and processed the jars in a boiling water canner for only 5 minutes.

IS THIS SAFE?

Alex made grape jelly but decided to skip adding any commercial pectin and relied on cooking the juice for an hour to achieve gel consistency before canning it using the boiling water canner.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Lisa noticed a fuzzy mold growing on her home-canned blueberry jam stored at room temperature after a year and decided to scrape off the mold and eat the jam.

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IS THIS SAFE?

David made a jam using low-methoxyl (low sugar needed) pectin but reduced the lemon juice suggested in the recipe by half, processing in a boiling water canner for 10 minutes.

IS THIS SAFE?

Emily is making plum jelly at 5,000 feet altitude but uses the standard boiling water canning processing time without adjustment.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Jill freezes a batch of freshly cooked chili, cooling it in shallow containers before placing them in the freezer set at 0°F (-18°C). She labels and dates each container for easy rotation.

IS THIS SAFE?

Tom places fresh fish fillets in airtight freezer bags with as much air removed as possible. He freezes them promptly in portions sized for single meals.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Mary thawed frozen ground beef at room temperature on the kitchen counter all afternoon before cooking it for dinner.

IS THIS SAFE?

Carlos stores canned vegetables in his unheated garage during winter. Some cans freeze, bulge, and have loose seams when thawed to room temperature.

IS THIS SAFE?

Anna freezes leftover cooked green beans in a regular storage bag without removing much air and notices freezer burn after a few weeks.

IS THIS SAFE?

Sarah freezes cooked pumpkin puree for use in pies later. She wonders if the pumpkin needs to be blanched first before freezing.

IS THIS SAFE?

Mark leaves thawed shrimp in the refrigerator at 45°F for 3 days before deciding whether to refreeze or cook it.

IS THIS SAFE?

Lauren refrigerates fresh eggs at 42°F instead of the recommended 40°F or below, wondering if the eggs are still safe for weekly use.

IS THIS SAFE?

Maria slices fresh peaches and spreads them evenly on dehydrator trays, then sets the dehydrator to 140°F for about 12 hours until the pieces are leathery but pliable. She stores the dried peaches in airtight containers in a cool, dark pantry.

IS THIS SAFE?

John cures pork belly with salt and smoke for several days in his home smoker, maintaining the smoker temperature at 150°F and hanging the meat so smoke circulates evenly. He uses a tested curing recipe from OSU Extension.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Laila dries raw chicken strips by layering them thickly on a dehydrator tray set at 130°F for 6 hours, skipping any pre-cooking or heating step before drying.

IS THIS SAFE?

Rick smokes salmon in a smoker where the temperature fluctuates between 100°F and 130°F, and sometimes the temperature drops below 100°F during the smoking session.

IS THIS SAFE?

Alice air-dries fresh herbs on a rack indoors at room temperature without controlling humidity or airflow, leaving the herbs in a damp kitchen for several days.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Carlos wants to dry sliced tomatoes using his home dehydrator but is unsure whether to pre-treat them with lemon juice or another acid before drying.

IS THIS SAFE?

Nina plans to smoke her home-cured summer sausage at about 110°F for 4 hours, then refrigerate it immediately afterward without a final cooking step.